PassFrame
TUITION

Midnight at the Museum

Year 4 — 11+ Lesson Worksheet (PassFrame Tuition)

Comprehension | Fiction

Extract — read it carefully before answering

Sam and his sister Priya had never meant to get locked in. They had simply lingered too long by the dinosaur skeletons on their school trip, and when they finally looked up, the rest of their class — and the daylight — had completely vanished.

'We have to find a way out,' whispered Priya, gripping Sam's sleeve as their footsteps echoed down the empty gallery. The museum felt entirely different at night: shadows stretched long and strange across the marble floor, and every statue seemed to watch them as they passed.

They had almost reached the main entrance when a torch beam swept suddenly across the hall, and a gruff voice called out, 'Who's there?' It was Mr Okafor, the night guard, his face breaking into surprise rather than anger when he spotted the two children.

'We got left behind,' Sam explained quickly, his voice wobbling slightly. 'We didn't mean any harm, honestly.'

Mr Okafor chuckled and shook his head. 'Well, you've picked an exciting night to explore,' he said, leading them towards the staff office to call their worried parents. 'Not many people get a private tour of the dinosaurs after dark.' Despite the fright, Sam couldn't help glancing back at the skeletons one last time, secretly rather glad of the adventure.

Questions

20 min · 12 questions

1. Why did Sam and Priya end up locked in the museum?

2. Who did Sam and Priya meet as they searched for the exit?

3. Underline the sentence that tells you Priya was nervous as they walked.

4. Underline the sentence that describes how the museum looked different at night.

5. What does “lingered” mean as it is used in the extract?

6. True or false: Mr Okafor was angry when he found the children.

7. Why do you think Sam's voice was “wobbling slightly” when he spoke to Mr Okafor?

8. What job does Mr Okafor do at the museum?

9. In your own words, explain how Sam felt by the very end of the extract.

10. What does the phrase “every statue seemed to watch them as they passed” suggest about the mood of the museum at night?

11. Why do you think the author chose dinosaur skeletons, rather than another exhibit, for this scene?

12. Do you think Sam and Priya should have been more careful earlier in the day? Explain your answer.